

URED-1201
Basic Principles of Islam
FINAL SUGGESTION

1. Ibadah

Ans: The word 'Ibadah' an Arabic word, came from its root word 'abd. Generally it means slave, full time servant or to serve.

Ibadah also means submission, obedience, service, worship etc.

Shaykhul- Islaam Ibn Taymiyyah said, "Worship is obedience to Allah by following that which He ordered upon the tongues of His Messengers." Finally we can say that, Ibadah refers to the Five pillars of Islam & other acts, such as supplications & Remembrance, that have a specifically ritual & devotional nature. Allah ordered us to worship of Him. He said, "I created Jinn & human kind only for worship of me."

Objectives/Purposes of "Ibadah"

'Ibadah' is the ultimate goal & only purpose of creation & its main objective is to attain Allah's satisfaction who is our Lord, our Sustainer. The following purposes persuade man to worship & serve Allah (SWT) :

1. Greatness of Allah : When man sees the greatness & magnificance of Allah, he unconsciously feels humble and weak before Him & worships Him.
2. Feelings of dependence on Allah: Our very existence depends upon the will of Allah & we need Him all the time. This feeling of need & deficiency urges men to worship Allah.
3. Awareness of blessings : Man loves to possess & enjoy blessings. Remembering the abundant blessing of Allah can be the strongest motive for worshipping Him.
4. Human nature : Worship is an instinctive & integral part of human nature.
5. Nourishment for the soul: Ibadah is nourishment for the soul, just like food and drink are for the body.
6. To attain Allah's satisfaction & get reward of Allah in Akhirah : The main aim of Ibadah is to attain satisfaction of Allah. It also denotes seeking paradise and deliverance from hell-fire.
7. Development of man's conscience : Worship is the only means for the proper development of man's conscience. It is the only source of good manners.
8. To be successful : A believer can perform Ibadah to be successful because it is the sign of success as Allah said: The believers must win through, Those who humble themselves in prayers, Who avoid vain talk, who are active in deeds of charity.

Types of Ibadah

There are different types of 'Ibadah' according to the different scholars described in below!

A. Some scholars state that "Ibadah is of two types."

1. Ibadah maqsudah e.g. salah, is an act pole of worship which is done only for the purposes of tahwab
2. Ibadah gayr maqsudah. e.g. wudhu, is an Ibadah which is performed for two reasons. To gain tahwab & to fulfill a condition for another Ibadah.

B. Some scholars categorized Ibadah into two kinds. ibball murabrog nos roveiled A

1. Ibadah Mahdhah: Means pure slavery wherein ot only an inter- slave relationship with Allah directly. ow
2. Ibadah ghairu Mahdhah. It is not just püerely related to Allah, as it has a relationship of a slave with Allah s also it has a interaction with Other creatures.

C. According to Imam Ibnul Qaiyim, it is divided into four categories:

1. The Jawl (sayings) of the heard.
2. The amal (action) of the heart.
3. The sayings of the tonguest.
4. The actions of the limbs.

Conditions of Ibadah

Main conditions of Ibadah in Islam are of three kinds:

1. Al-Iman: Iman is to believe firmly by heart without any doubt in Allah, His angels, His books as completed by the Quran, His prophets and proved in work.
2. Al-Ikhlās: Ikhlas is intending to practice all works only to get satisfaction of Allah.
3. Approved by Shariah: Ibadah would be practice by direction of shariah, by following the way of prophet Muhammad (SAW).

Secondary condition:

1. Earning a lawful income
2. To refrain from ria.
3. To avoid great sin Nobility in deeds.
4. Nobility in deeds.
5. Seeking favor from Allah.
6. Giving people their rights.

Characteristics of Ibadah in Islam

- a) First characteristic: Free from Intermediation Islam has liberated worship from the bondage of intermediaries between man & his creation. No one is considered to be entitled to accept or reject acts of worship on behalf of Allah. Allah (SWT) ordered us to perform Ibadah' directly without making any media. There is not a single verse of the Holy Quran or sunnah be found where Allah permitted to seek any person as intermediary during offering "the acts of Ibadah. Ibadah is only fore Allah the One, inclusively & exclusively.
- b) time, but Islam is not limited to any place, duration, race or community. Thus all activities of Islam are not confined to specific time and places except a few acts like acts of obligatory salah & hajj.
- c) Third characteristic: All- embracing view. Thirdly, Islam has also considerably widened the scope of worship. In Islam, worship is not confined to specified prayers & Litanies, which are to be performed on particular Occasions. Rather, Islam considers every virtuous action, which has been sincerely performed, and with the view to carry out the commandments of Allah & in order to seek His pleasure, an act of worship for which man will be rewarded.

Characteristic of Ibad ur Rahman

The meaning of Ibad ur Rehman is: Worshippers of Allah, or devoted servant of Allah. In Surah Al-Furqan, Allah provides a glimpse of some of the characteristics of His slaves that he calls "Ibad-ur-Rahman".

Characteristics of the Mumins according to Surah Al-Muminoon. (Ibad-ur-Rehman)

1. Those who offer their salat with all solemnity and full submissiveness
2. Those who turn away from false/ill speech.
3. They who are observant of zakah.
4. They who guard their private parts. Except from their wives or what their right hands possess, for then, they are free from blame.!
5. Those who are faithfully true to their Amaanat and to their covenants.
6. And those who strictly guard their five compulsory Salaat.
7. Those are the inheritors who will inherit al-Firdaus.

Characteristics of Mumin according to Surah Al-Furqan:

1. The faithful slaves (Ibaad-ur-Rehman) walk on the earth with modesty, don't walk with pride.
2. They pray before Allah; they worship Him. They spend part of their nights prostrating and standing before Allah (SWT).
3. The obedient slaves of Almighty Allah pray that He saves them from the doom, the punishment of hell.
4. They spend their wealth reasonably according to the command of God.
5. Those who cry to Allah and do not call upon any other except Him.

6. They don't kill anyone except on the divine order.
7. They do not commit adultery.
8. They ask for God's repentance if they've done something wrong.
9. They ask God to keep themselves and their children on the right path.

Salat

The word 'Salat' is an Arabic word. In Shariah, salat is defined as a type of worship consisting of specific statements & actions.

It is begun by pronouncing the greatness of Allah & is concluded with salutations of peace.

Importance and significance of Salah:

1. The pillar of Islam: It is the second pillar of Islam that the Prophet mentioned.
2. The foundation of Religion: It is considered to be the foundation of religion as the Prophet Muhammad (SAW) also said: "The prayer is the foundation of Islam, so who establishes it, establishes the Deen, & who destroys it, destroys the Deen."
3. Salah is an obligatory act: Salah was made obligatory upon all the prophets for all people. Allah has declared its obligatory status under majestic circumstances.
4. The most virtuous deed: The Prophet stated that most virtuous deed is the prayer.
5. Company of the prophet: One of the greatest causes to enter Paradise with the company of the Prophet is salah.
6. Relationship between Allah & believer.
7. The first matter will be accounted on the day of judgement.
8. Salah prevents from vices.
9. Allatis forgiveness & pleasure.
10. It removes the sins: The prayers are a type of purification for a human being. He turns & meets with his Lord, five times a day. As alluded to above, this repeated standing in front of Allah should keep the person from performing sins during the day.

Comprehensive effects of Salah

1. Spiritual effects of Salah: The performance of prayer five times a day is considered vital to attain success in this life and hereafter. It purifies the heart and through prayer, a believer attains spiritual devotion and moral elevation. It is also a source of patience, courage, hope, confidence, and inner peace.
2. Physical effects of Salah: One may gain many physical and psychological benefits from performing Salat.
 - a. Ruku increased blood flow to the upper body, making the spine supple and flexible.
 - b. Sujud mentions increased blood supply to the brain, improving memory, vision, hearing, concentration, and the psyche.
3. Psychological effects: Prayer is a psychology therapy that helps calm the soul & relieves all tension. It also constitutes a successful treatment for insomnia resulting in dysfunction of the nervous system.

4. Social effects: Salah especially congregational prayer is a prelude to unity among the ranks, closeness of hearts & promotion of the spirit of brotherhood. It is a sort of free-of-charge meeting, familiarity with each others & a platform for social cooperation among Muslims.
5. Political effects: Salah is a symbol of the power of Muslims, closeness of hearts & their solidarity in their unity of purpose. Congregational prayer is the link between the Imam & the ummah.

Prerequisites & Arkan of Salah

Precondition:

1. Belief in Allah
2. Purity of body & cloths
3. Purity of the place of prayer
4. Covering the body properly (Awrah)
5. Facing the direction of prayer
6. Praying Salah at the appropriate time
7. Having proper Niyyah/intention in the heart

In-condition:

1. Performing Qiyam (standing)
2. Takbiratul Thram (the opening takbir)
3. Qirat (Reciting the Holy Quran)
4. Performing Ruku
5. Performing Sijdah
6. Qu'dah Al Akhirah (last sitting)

Zakah

Zakah can be defined as that portion of a man's wealth which is designated for the poor. The term is derived from the Arabic verbal root meaning, "to increase", "to purify". It finds its origin in Allah's command to:

"Take sadaqah from their property in order to purify and sanctify them." That's why this kind of sadaqah is called Zakah, for by paying it, one is aspiring to attain blessing, purification & the cultivation of good deeds. Nisab is to have a fixed amount of surplus wealth after fulfilling the basic needs.

Wealth on which zakah is obligatory:

1. Zakah on gold & silver.
2. Zakah on debt.
3. Zakah on banknotes & debt.
4. Zakah on jewellery.
5. On a woman's dowry.

6. On house rent.
7. On trade.
8. On plants & fruits.
9. On olives.
10. On honey.
11. On buried treasure & precious minerals.

The nisab of gold & its due: The minimum of nisab for gold is twenty dinars owned for one year. Its due is a quarter of a tenth, that is, half a dinar.

The nisab of silver & its due: There is no zakah on silver until the amount exceeds two hundred dirhams. The amount payable is a quarter of a tenth for any amount.

Due recipients of Zakah

There are eight categories of the beneficiaries of Zakah which Allah specifies in the Quran:

1. The poor (al-Fuqara)
2. The needy (al-Masakin)
3. Collectors of Zakah
4. Who return in muslim.
5. Debtors: Who are loan affected
6. In the way of Allah
7. Freeing captives (Contracted slaves & regular slaves)
8. For the Wayfarer (Muslim traveler)

Role of Zakah:

1. Third pillar of Islam
2. Compulsory from Allah
3. Compulsory for Muslims
4. Zakah is a believe
5. Financial worship
6. Right for needy person
7. Moral sphere

Role of Zakah in Poverty Alleviation:

Islam defines poverty based on an individual's failure to fulfill any of the five basic human requirements of life. That is:

1. Religion

2. Physical needs
3. Knowledge
4. Dignity
5. Wealth

Islam views poverty as a social problem because the effects are felt in the society as a whole. In Islam, zakah plays an important role in poverty alleviation & socioeconomic development. It attempts to promote an equitable redistribution of wealth & fosters a sense of solidarity among members of the community. The ultimate goals of zakah are to reduce inequality & to establish human rights, social justice & poverty reduction in Muslim communities. This sense of collective responsibility is further reinforced by how Muslims view their within society. It is believed, if the zakah system is enforced in letter & spirit, then extreme poverty can be eliminated.

Siyam

As-Siyam is the plural form of sawm, and generally means "to abstain from something". Sawm is abstaining from food, drink & sexual intercourse from dawn until sunset with the explicit intention of doing so (for the sake of Allah).

Sawm is one of the five pillars of Islam. Like Salah & Zakah, it is another important institution of Islam.

Importance of Sawm:

1. Fasting in Ramadan is one of the five pillars of Islam, constituting one of the most important spiritual practices.
2. A hearty, secret worship that concerns only the servant and his Creator.
3. Fasting in Ramadan purifies the mind, body, and spirit, leading to greater clarity, sensitivity, and health.
4. A unique opportunity to develop spirituality and gain strength and control over ourselves, our nafs, and egos.
5. Attain taqwa, that is, God-wariness.
6. Fasting in Ramadan keeps the body healthy and youthful.
7. Renewing solidarity and cultivating relationships with one's family and community.
8. By fasting in Ramadan, we develop the holy qualities of empathy and compassion.
9. Best way to acquire taqwa.
10. Way to get forgiveness of Allah.
11. Opportunity to enter the Jannah by the fixed gate.

Invalidators of Sawm:

1. Putting food or drinks into the mouth intentionally.
2. To eat & drink by forgetting & to continue it after remembering.
3. Taking medicine intentionally.
4. Breaking fast before sunset.

5. Breaking fast by smoking.
6. Going down water into throat during gargling.
7. Vomiting willingly.
8. Engaging in sexual intercourse.
9. Putting oil into ear.
10. Swallowing the rain-drop that has entered his mouth.

Hajj

Hajj linguistically signifies frequent visita. According to the Shariah, Hajj mean's visiting the sacred House of Allah to perform certain rituals or acts of worship during the months of Hajj. A pilgrim is called "Al-Hajj."

Importance & significance of Hajj:

1. One of the best deeds: Prophet (SAW) mentioned hajj as one of the best deed.
2. A form of Jihad: Prophet (SAW) graded hajj as Jihad.
3. Wipes off past sins. An accepted hajj wipes off part sins of a pilgrim & he will return after hajj free from all sim.
4. Pilgrims are guests: Those performing hajj umrah are Allah's guests.
5. The reward of hajj is paradise.
6. A model of simplicity.
7. A model of piety & fear of Allah.
8. A model of peace & security.

Essentials (Arkan) of Hajj:

There are only two essential parts of Hajj according to Hanafi Fiqh:

1. 9th Zul Hijjah stay at the ground of 'Arafah between the sun's descent from the zenith on the 9th and the dawn-break on the 10th of Zhul Hijjah.
2. Tawaf al-Ziyarah of the Ka'bah with seven times after the 'Arafah stay.

Compulsory acts of Hajj:

1. Ihram at the prescribed station or prior to reaching there. It must be done during the months of Hajj.
2. Throwing the pebbles at the Jamarat.
3. Avoiding all the sinful activities & behavior that may invalidate the Hajj.
4. Tawaf of arrival.
5. Salah of Tawaf.
6. Sa'i between the two hills, Safa & Marwah.
7. Shaving or trimming of hair.

8. Farewell Tawaf.
9. Spending some time in Muzdalifah.